

Rukhsar Laeeq

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EDUCATION

Lahore College For Women University

M.Phil Economics

2023-2025

CGPA: 3.14 (72.3%)

Relevant Coursework: Applied Econometrics, Monetary Economics, Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Research Methods

Lahore College For Women University

BS Economics

2019-2023

CGPA 3.31 (75.4%)

Relevant Coursework: Macro-Microeconomics, International Economics, Econometrics, Research Appraisal, Public Finance

FSC Pre Engineering (71%) | APWA College, Lahore

2017-2019

Matriculation Science (77%) | Moon Public Girls High School, Lahore

2015 – 2017

RESEARCH WORK

Thesis: Why Has Pakistan Fallen Behind in Human Development Index?

2024 - 2025

Supervisor: Dr. Hafiz Pasha and Dr. Muhammad Afzal

- Investigated why Pakistan lags behind in Human Development Index (HDI), with a particular focus on the role of public education expenditure in improving educational outcomes.
- Conducted a comprehensive literature review on human development, education financing, and the relationship between public expenditure and enrolment in developing countries.
- Examined the impact of real current and real development education expenditure at the primary and secondary levels on enrolment rates using annual time-series data (1999–2023) obtained from PRSP Reports, Pakistan Bureau of Statistics (PBS), and the World Development Indicators (WDI).
- Performed HDI decomposition analysis comparing Pakistan with Bangladesh to identify the relative contributions of education, health, and income to the human development gap.
- Found that education is the largest contributor to Pakistan's lower HDI relative to Bangladesh.
- Applied Ordinary Least Squares (OLS) regression after conducting diagnostic tests to ensure that the assumptions of multiple regression were satisfied.
- Found that real current education expenditure significantly increases primary school enrolment, while both real current and real development expenditures significantly improve secondary school enrolment, highlighting the importance of efficient resource allocation and investment in education.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Punjab SDG Support Unit, UNDP Pakistan Intern | 1st July 2026 – Present

- Conducted SDGs data collection, and quantitative analysis to track progress on sustainable development indicators.
- Performed social sector analysis covering 12 to 15 schemes.
- Analysed the Annual Development Programme (ADP) to assess budget allocations and expenditure trends aligned with SDG targets.
- Prepared policy briefs and research summaries on the Human Development Index (HDI), synthesizing complex findings and presenting evidence based insights to senior staff and development partners

Lahore Chamber of Commerce and Industry, R&D Intern | June 2022 – August 2022

- Conducted quantitative research and prepared 6+ analytical reports on Pakistan's economy.
- Researched Pakistan's top export destinations and export trends.
- Analyzed research on e-commerce and its economic implications.
- Contributed to research on Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), with a focus on Gender Mainstreaming.
- Prepared analytical research report on Indonesian investment in Pakistan.
- Conducted research and analysis on the Punjab Power Saving Plan.

SKILLS

Research Expertise: Experienced in preparing comprehensive research reports and data-driven policy briefs, conducting critical literature reviews of 30+ academic papers to identify research gaps, performing quantitative data analysis and econometric research, interpreting complex datasets, and presenting and defending research findings before academic panels while effectively responding to technical queries.

Econometric Methods: Regression analysis, time series, cross-sectional, and panel data

Technical Proficiency: Stata, EViews, RStudio, SPSS

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

ACP British Council Project : Climate Awareness 2022

Role: Public Service Messages (4 month duration)

- Developed and delivered climate awareness content.
- Created a public service video to promote environmental awareness and community engagement.

Participate in Fundraising activities for cancer

CERTIFICATES

Econometric Analysis in R with Spatial fundamentals | LCWU 2023

BIBLIOMETRIC ANALYSIS WORKSHOP | LCWU 2022